

## SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

# Soul: Immortality, Rebirth and Liberation - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

### LEARNING PATH



*Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.*

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Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

# CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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# Soul: Immortality, Rebirth and Liberation - Solved Practice Workbook

## BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

### Practice protocol - [CORE ANSWER]

Attempt every item before reading its key. The correct-option sequence rotates strictly A -> B -> C -> D across all forty-eight diagnostics.

### ORIGINAL MCQ MASTERY SET - EXACTLY 48 QUESTIONS

Questions 1-40 are core coverage - four per subtopic across the ten subtopics; Questions 41-48 are remedial items targeting the most common misreadings. Correct answers rotate strictly A -> B -> C -> D 12 times.

#### MCQ 1

On the six survival-terms, which statement is correct?

A. Rebirth is a wider term than reincarnation.

B. Resurrection is a form of transmigration. C. Liberation is simply a synonym for heaven. D. Immortality and survival make exactly the same claim. **Correct answer: A**

**Explanation:** Rebirth (esp. Buddhist punarbhava) is the wider term; reincarnation assumes a substance re-enfleshed, resurrection is one life, and liberation is exit from the cycle, not heaven.

#### MCQ 2

'Immortality of a substantial soul is \_\_\_\_ for rebirth.' The best completion is:

A. neither necessary nor sufficient B. sufficient but not necessary C. necessary and sufficient D. necessary but not sufficient

**Correct answer: B**

**Explanation:** B persisting soul would guarantee rebirth (sufficient), but Buddhism shows a soul is not required (not necessary).

#### MCQ 3

The decisive counter-example to 'rebirth requires an immortal soul' is:

A. Advaita Vedanta B. Nyaya-Vaisesika C. Buddhism D. Jainism

**Correct answer: C**

**Explanation:** Buddhism affirms rebirth (punarbhava) while denying a permanent self (anatman).

#### MCQ 4

Calling 'liberation' a family-resemblance term means:

- A. it is meaningless across schools
  - B. it always denotes union with God
  - C. all schools mean the same state by it
  - D. it covers several non-identical destinations that share one label
- Correct answer: D**

**Explanation:** Identity, communion, cessation, isolation and perfected individuality share the label 'liberation' without sharing one content.

#### MCQ 5

Plato's recollection (anamnesis) argument most directly establishes:

- A. the soul's pre-existence
  - B. the soul's post-mortem survival on its own
  - C. the mortality of the body
  - D. bodily resurrection
- Correct answer: A**

**Explanation:** Recollection infers that the soul knew the Forms before birth -- pre-existence, which is not yet post-mortem survival.

#### MCQ 6

Which is Plato's culminating ('final') argument in the Phaedo?

- A. the recollection argument
- B. the argument from the Form of Life
- C. the affinity argument
- D. the argument from opposites

**Correct answer: B**

**Explanation:** The final argument holds that the soul essentially brings Life and so cannot admit its opposite, death.

#### MCQ 7

Simmias objects to Plato that the soul is:

- A. immortal by affinity to the Forms
- B. identical with the Forms
- C. a harmony/attunement of the body
- D. a simple substance

**Correct answer: C**

**Explanation:** The harmony objection makes the soul depend on the body; Plato replies the soul rules the body and pre-exists it.

### MCQ 8

Kant's paralogism, applied to immortality, shows that:

- A. the soul is a knowable substance
  - B. recollection proves survival
  - C. the soul is material
  - D. the soul's permanence cannot be demonstrated as a substance
- Correct answer: D**

**Explanation:** Kant denies that the soul is a knowable substance, so its indestructibility cannot be proved a priori.

### MCQ 9

The three kinds of karma are:

- A. sancita, prarabdha and agami
  - B. asrava, bandha and nirjara
  - C. jnana, karma and bhakti
  - D. sattva, rajas and tamas
- Correct answer: A**

**Explanation:** Sancita (stored), prarabdha (now ripening) and agami (future) classify karmic debt.

### MCQ 10

Rebirth is significant in karma theory chiefly because it:

- A. abolishes moral responsibility
- B. provides the field in which fruits maturing beyond one life are discharged
- C. proves the existence of God
- D. guarantees memory of past lives

**Correct answer: B**

**Explanation:** Karma outruns a single life, so rebirth is the field where karmic fruits ripen.

### MCQ 11

The claim that karma is NOT fatalism rests on:

- A. the subtle body
- B. adrista alone
- C. purusakara operating within daiva
- D. prarabdha alone

**Correct answer: C**

**Explanation:** Personal effort (purasakara) works within the given (daiva); present effort shapes future (agami) karma.

### MCQ 12

Gita 9.21 (return from heaven once merit is exhausted) shows that:

- A. karma is unreal
- B. resurrection occurs in heaven
- C. heaven is final liberation
- D. even heaven is a within-samsara stage, not liberation

**Correct answer: D**

**Explanation:** Heavenly sojourn ends in return to the mortal world, so it is inside samsara.

### MCQ 13

In Buddhism, what is 'reborn' is best described as:

A. a dependently arisen causal stream B. an eternal atman C. a transmigrating substance D. a resurrected body

**Correct answer: A**

**Explanation:** Rebirth is causal continuity of dependently arisen aggregates, not a soul.

### MCQ 14

'Neither the same nor wholly other' answers the objection that:

A. Buddhism is nihilist B. if no self persists, who receives the karmic fruit? C. anatman denies conventional persons D. the flame analogy is a proof

**Correct answer: B**

**Explanation:** The later stream is causally descended from the earlier -- enough for moral responsibility without substance-identity.

### MCQ 15

The flame-to-flame illustration is properly used as:

A. a proof of rebirth B. a proof of anatman C. a model of continuity without numerical identity D. evidence of an immortal soul

**Correct answer: C**

**Explanation:** It illustrates a continuity-model; it is never a demonstration.

### MCQ 16

The philosophical significance of the anti-theistic stand on rebirth is that rebirth is shown to be:

A. impossible without God  
B. identical to resurrection C. dependent on an immortal soul D. separable from both a creator-God and a soul-substance **Correct answer: D**

**Explanation:** Buddhism (and Jainism) run karma-rebirth-liberation without a judging God or a transmigrating substance.

### MCQ 17

In Nyaya apavarga, consciousness in the liberated state is:

A. absent  
B. omniscient C. infinite bliss D. non-dual awareness **Correct answer: A**

**Explanation:** Consciousness is adventitious to the Nyaya self, so apavarga ends pain and consciousness alike -- a negative state.

### MCQ 18

Which pair correctly matches liberation-term to school?

- A. moksa -- Buddhism B. apavarga -- Nyaya-Vaisesika  
C. kaivalya -- Advaita D. nirvana -- Jainism **Correct answer: B**

**Explanation:** Apavarga is the Nyaya-Vaisesika term; kaivalya is Samkhya-Yoga, nirvana is Buddhist, and Buddhism does not use moksa in the Vedantic sense.

### MCQ 19

Jivanmukti differs from videhamukti in that jivanmukti is:

- A. liberation of the body itself B. liberation only after death C. liberation attained while still embodied D. the resurrection of the person

**Correct answer: C**

**Explanation:** Jivanmukti is freedom while living; videhamukti is at the body's fall.

### MCQ 20

Griffiths' formula that Advaitic moksa is 'not acquired but acknowledged' means:

- A. moksa is a future heavenly reward  
B. moksa is produced by ritual action C. moksa requires bodily resurrection D. liberation removes an error and the self was free all along **Correct answer: D**

**Explanation:** Bondage is avidya/adhyasa, so knowledge only removes the superimposition.

### MCQ 21

For Visistadvaita, in liberation the jiva:

- A. persists eternally in communion with God B. loses all consciousness C. is annihilated D. becomes numerically identical with Brahman

**Correct answer: A**

**Explanation:** The jiva is an eternal mode of God, freed into service/communion, never becoming God.

### MCQ 22

The 'real agent' problem is a difficulty primarily for:

- A. Visistadvaita B. Advaita  
C. Nyaya D. Jainism **Correct answer: B**

**Explanation:** If ultimate individuality is denied, Advaita must explain who is bound and freed; it appeals to conventional agency until insight.

### MCQ 23

In Advaita, bondage is fundamentally:

- A. the isolation of purusa from prakrti B. karmic matter clinging to the soul C. avidya, a beginningless superimposition (adhyasa) D. dependence on God

**Correct answer: C**

**Explanation:** Bondage is ignorance -- the rope-snake superimposition -- removable only by knowledge.

### MCQ 24

For Sankara, the direct means to liberation is:

- A. bhakti as prapatti  
B. karma alone C. ritual injunction D. jnana, because bondage is ignorance **Correct answer: D**

**Explanation:** Since liberation is the removal of avidya, only knowledge removes it; Sankara rejects jnana-karma-samuccaya.

### MCQ 25

In Jainism, the influx of karmic matter into the soul is called:

- A. asrava B. nirjara C. samvara D. bandha

**Correct answer: A**

**Explanation:** Asrava is influx; bandha is bondage, samvara is stoppage, nirjara is shedding.

### MCQ 26

The stoppage of fresh karmic influx is:

- A. asrava B. samvara C. nirjara D. kevala

**Correct answer: B**

**Explanation:** Samvara halts new influx; nirjara then sheds accumulated matter.

### MCQ 27

Jain liberation is best described as:

- A. contentless isolation of purusa B. identity with Brahman C. perfected omniscient individuality D. cessation of the causal stream

**Correct answer: C**

**Explanation:** The freed jiva manifests ananta-catustaya (infinite knowledge, perception, bliss, energy) -- individuality perfected, not dissolved.



### MCQ 28

Jain kevala differs from Samkhya kaivalya because Jain kevala means:

- A. cessation of consciousness
- B. contentless isolation
- C. union with a personal God
- D. omniscience (kevala-jnana) **Correct answer: D**

**Explanation:** Same syllable, opposite content: Jain kevala is omniscience; Samkhya kaivalya is contentless isolation.

### MCQ 29

Samkhya-karika 62-63 states that, strictly, what is bound and released is:

- A. prakrti, not purusa
- B. Isvara
- C. purusa, not prakrti
- D. the individual buddhi acting alone **Correct answer: A**

**Explanation:** No purusa is bound, released or transmigrating; prakrti binds and releases herself -- the misattribution is the whole doctrine.

### MCQ 30

The potter's-wheel image (SK 67) illustrates:

- A. Isvara as creator
- B. the body persisting on residual momentum after discriminative knowledge
- C. the plurality of purusas
- D. the creation of the world

**Correct answer: B**

**Explanation:** The wheel spins on after the hand withdraws -- like the body after viveka-khyati; it parallels Advaita's prarabdha image.

### MCQ 31

Yoga-sutra 1.24 characterises Isvara as:

- A. identical with prakrti
- B. the karmic judge of souls
- C. a special purusa untouched by karma
- D. the material cause of the world **Correct answer: C**

**Explanation:** Isvara is a special purusa, object of pranidhana -- theism without creation.

### MCQ 32

Samkhya-Yoga kaivalya is best described as:

- A. omniscient perfection
- B. identity with Brahman
- C. communion with a personal God
- D. the isolation of contentless pure consciousness

**Correct answer: D**

**Explanation:** Kaivalya is aloneness -- purusa standing in its own nature, explicitly not bliss.

### MCQ 33

The nine limbs of devotion (navadha bhakti) are enumerated in:

A. Bhagavata Purana 7.5.23 B. Yoga-sutra 1.24 C. Samkhya-karika 62 D. Bhagavad Gita 18.66

**Correct answer: A**

**Explanation:** Bhagavata 7.5.23 lists sravana, kirtana, smarana, pada-sevana, arcana, vandana, dasya, sakhya, atma-nivedana.

### MCQ 34

Sankara rejects jnana-karma-samuccaya because he holds that liberation is:

A. attained by ritual alone B. the removal of ignorance, not a produced effect C. a graded combination of all means D. produced by action

**Correct answer: B**

**Explanation:** On the removal model, only knowledge dispels avidya; action merely purifies.

### MCQ 35

The marjara-nyaya versus markata-nyaya dispute concerns:

A. the number of purusas B. the correct definition of karma C. the relation of grace and effort in liberation D. the reality of the world

**Correct answer: C**

**Explanation:** Cat-hold (grace alone) versus monkey-hold (grace plus effort) is the tradition's own statement of the grace-effort problem.

### MCQ 36

The Vivekacudamani definition of bhakti should be attributed to:

A. Ramanuja  
B. Madhva C. Sankara personally D. the Advaita tradition, since the ascription to Sankara is disputed **Correct answer: D**

**Explanation:** Provenance discipline: say 'the Advaita tradition', never 'Sankara wrote'.

### MCQ 37

Oscar Cullmann (1955) argues that immortality of the soul and resurrection of the dead are:

A. theologically opposed, not complementary B. two names for one doctrine C. both forms of rebirth D. both Greek in origin

**Correct answer: A**

**Explanation:** Cullmann's thesis is that the Greek and Hebrew-Christian conceptions are opposed.

### MCQ 38

'Reincarnation', in careful usage, differs from 'rebirth' because reincarnation:

- A. denies any continuity between lives
- B. presupposes a substantial soul re-entering flesh
- C. applies straightforwardly to Buddhism
- D. is the wider, more neutral term

**Correct answer: B**

**Explanation:** Reincarnation assumes a substance re-enfleshed; rebirth is wider and the only correct term for Buddhism.

### MCQ 39

Hick's replica theory is best presented as:

- A. a Vedantic doctrine of liberation
  - B. a proof of the soul's natural immortality
  - C. a thought-experiment defence of resurrection identity
  - D. a denial of personal identity
- Correct answer: C**

**Explanation:** An exact, unique psychophysical replica is argued to be the same person; the duplication objection is the standard reply.

### MCQ 40

Which reply to the resurrection re-assembly problem is correctly paired?

- A. Aquinas -- an exact replica in another space
  - B. Hick -- the soul is the form of the body
  - C. Cullmann -- God substitutes a simulacrum
  - D. van Inwagen -- God preserves a core of the body
- Correct answer: D**

**Explanation:** Aquinas = soul as form; Hick = replica; van Inwagen = God preserves a core or leaves a simulacrum.

### Remedial MCQ 41

A common error is to say Buddhism denies continuity. Correctly, Buddhism denies:

- A. a permanent substance-self, not continuity
  - B. causation of any kind
  - C. rebirth altogether
  - D. moral responsibility
- Correct answer: A**

**Explanation:** Anatman denies a permanent self, while the causal stream secures continuity.

### Remedial MCQ 42

A frequent trap calls Nyaya apavarga 'positive bliss'. Correctly, apavarga is:

- A. the isolation of purusa
- B. the cessation of pain and of consciousness
- C. union with a personal God
- D. omniscient perfection

**Correct answer: B**

**Explanation:** Consciousness is adventitious to the Nyaya self, so apavarga is release from pain, not beatitude.

### Remedial MCQ 43

Students merge kaivalya and kevala. In Samkhya kaivalya is \_\_\_\_; in Jainism kevala is \_\_\_\_:

- A. communion; identity
- B. bliss; cessation
- C. contentless isolation; omniscience
- D. omniscience; contentless isolation

**Correct answer: C**

**Explanation:** Same syllable, opposite content -- Samkhya isolation versus Jain omniscience.

### Remedial MCQ 44

It is wrong to say 'Advaita rejects bhakti'. Advaita treats bhakti as:

- A. wholly irrelevant to liberation
  - B. the direct means to moksha
  - C. a fifth purusartha above liberation
  - D. preparatory (citta-suddhi), qualifying one for jnana
- Correct answer: D**

**Explanation:** Bhakti is a difference of ROLE, not of value: it purifies and qualifies, and jnana alone removes ignorance.

#### Remedial MCQ 45

The best correction to 'all Indian liberation is merger with God' is that it is false for:

A. Nyaya, Samkhya and Buddhism B. Jainism only C. no school at all D. Advaita and Visistadvaita

**Correct answer: A**

**Explanation:** Nyaya apavarga, Samkhya kaivalya and Buddhist nirvana involve no merger with God.

#### Remedial MCQ 46

Presenting resurrection as 'rebirth in heaven' is wrong because resurrection is:

A. an exit from samsara B. one life, a bodily re-constitution by divine act, with final judgement C. a beginningless karmic series D. driven by karma maturing across lives

**Correct answer: B**

**Explanation:** Resurrection is the opposite structure to samsara: linear, eschatological, and divinely enacted.

#### Remedial MCQ 47

The 'convergence' reading of jnana/karma/bhakti is best defended by saying they converge in \_\_\_\_ and diverge in \_\_\_\_:

A. text; author B. grace; effort C. function; terminus D. terminus; function

**Correct answer: C**

**Explanation:** They converge in function (removing egoic self-appropriation) but diverge in terminus (identity vs communion).

#### Remedial MCQ 48

Calling Yoga's Isvara a 'creator' is a trap; YS 1.24 makes Isvara:

A. the karmic judge of all souls  
B. numerically identical with Brahman C. the material cause of the world D. a special purusa, object of pranidhana, not the ground of the world **Correct answer: D**

**Explanation:** Yoga is the decisive Indian case of theism without creation.

## PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

### Ten-unit exam-application bridge

#### The Six Survival-Terms and the Necessity Question

#### LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

This subtopic is the engine room for every "necessary condition" stem and the "presupposition of religion" stem.

- 2022 Q5(c), 10 marks -- immortality a necessary postulate for rebirth, w.r.t.

Buddhism -> the modal verdict lives here.

- 2024 Q6(a), 20 marks -- must we adhere to immortality and rebirth for a robust conception of liberation -> chain all three terms.

- 2025 Q7(c), 15 marks -- immortality a necessary condition for rebirth, w.r.t.

the Bhagavad Gita -> same modal spine, Gita-specific evidence.

- 2020 Q5(b), 10 marks -- immortality a basic presupposition of religion.

MEMORY: 10-mark necessity spine -> define the disputed necessity -> give the substantialist YES -> deploy the Buddhist counter-example -> close with the exact modal claim (sufficient, not necessary).

## Immortality of the Soul: Plato's Four Proofs and the Western Critique

### LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

- 2023 Q6(a), 20 marks -- critically examine Plato's apriori proofs -> FOUR mini-assessments, never one summary. This subtopic is the whole answer.
- 2021 Q6(a), 20 marks -- immortality of soul w.r.t. Hindu tradition -> use Plato as the Western foil, then Vedanta/Nyaya/Jain eternal-self doctrines.
- 2020 Q5(b), 10 marks -- immortality as presupposition of religion -> Plato + the resurrection route.

MEMORY: 20-mark Plato spine -> state each of the 4 arguments -> assess each for validity AND for whether it reaches survival, not just pre-existence -> Simmias objection and reply -> Kant's paralogism -> verdict: suggestive, not probative.

## Rebirth: Karma, Samsara and the Buddhist Challenge

### LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

- 2023 Q7(b), 15 marks -- significance of rebirth in the theory of Karma.
- 2019 Q8(a), 20 marks -- Karma, Rebirth and Reincarnation (define each, then interlock; the reincarnation-vs-rebirth cut is delivered in Subtopic 10).
- 2021 Q8(b), 15 marks -- Karma as an essential postulate of Hinduism.
- 2022 Q5(c) / 2025 Q7(c) -- the necessity stems draw their rebirth content here.

MEMORY: 15-mark karma spine -> define karma (act + adṛṣṭa) and its three kinds -> rebirth as the field where fruits mature -> Buddhist continuity twist -> memory + desert objections and replies -> verdict on continuity vs substance.

## Buddhist Rebirth Without a Soul: Anatman and Causal Continuity

### LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

- 2022 Q5(c), 10 marks -- immortality a necessary postulate for rebirth, w.r.t. Buddhism -> this subtopic is the core of the answer.
- 2018 Q5(b), 10 marks -- philosophical significance of anti-theistic religions' stand on rebirth -> continuity-without-substance + morality-without-God.
- 2024 Q6(a), 20 marks -- Buddhism as the case that liberation is coherent without an eternal soul.

MEMORY: 10-mark Buddhism spine -> substantialist assumption stated -> anatman + pratītyasamutpāda -> flame/milk models -> "who reaps the fruit?" reply -> verdict: immortality sufficient, not necessary; Buddhism is decisive.

## Liberation Across Schools: the Parity Bench

### LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

- 2024 Q5(c), 10 marks -- apavarga in Nyaya-Vaisesika (cessation, no bliss).
- 2025 Q5(d), 10 marks -- jīvanmukti in Advaita (embodied liberation).
- 2021 Q6(b), 15 marks -- Advaita liberation + the role of knowledge.
- 2022 Q7(b), 15 marks -- liberation without a real agent (Advaita vs Viśiṣṭadvaita).
- 2024 Q6(a), 20 marks -- immortality + rebirth for a robust liberation.

MEMORY: Whenever a stem names a liberation-term, FIRST fix it on the §5A bench. Half the marks in this clause are lost to term-merging.

### Vedantic Atman, Rebirth and Moksa: Advaita versus Visistadvaita

#### LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

- 2021 Q6(b), 15 marks -- Advaita liberation + role of knowledge.
- 2022 Q7(b), 15 marks -- liberation without a real agent: Advaita vs

Visistadvaita -> this subtopic IS the answer.

- 2021 Q6(a), 20 marks -- immortality of soul w.r.t. Hindu tradition -> Vedantic atman is the centre of gravity.

MEMORY: 15-mark agent spine -> state the paradox -> Advaita's conventional- agency reply (sublation, not annihilation) -> Visistadvaita's real-jiva answer -> role of knowledge vs grace -> verdict fixing each conception of moksa.

### Jain Jiva and Bondage: the Karmic-Matter Ladder

#### LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

- 2022 Q8(b), 15 marks -- nature of Soul and Bondage in Jainism -> this subtopic is the whole answer; deliver jiva metaphysics AND the karmic ladder.

- Feeds the parity bench (Subtopic 5) and the 2024 robust-liberation stem with the "perfected individuality" contrast.

MEMORY: 15-mark Jain spine -> jiva (eternal, conscious, body-sized) -> asrava -> bandha -> samvara -> nirjara -> kevala with ananta-catustaya -> distinguish from Advaita identity and Buddhist cessation -> note the interaction problem.

### Cessation and Isolation: Nyaya Apavarga, Advaita Jivanmukti and Samkhya-Yoga Kaivalya

#### LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

- 2024 Q5(c), 10 marks -- apavarga in Nyaya-Vaisesika (cessation, no bliss/ consciousness) -> half this subtopic.
- 2025 Q5(d), 10 marks -- jivanmukti in Advaita -> the prarabdha spun-wheel.
- Samkhya-Yoga kaivalya drill -> isolation, not identity or bliss; SK 62-63.

MEMORY: 10-mark apavarga spine -> Nyaya suffering-chain -> true knowledge reverses it -> cessation of pain AND consciousness -> contrast with Advaita bliss and Samkhya isolation -> verdict: liberation as cessation, not reward.

### Paths to Liberation: Bhakti, and the Jnana-Karma-Bhakti Question

#### LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

- 2018 Q7(c), 15 marks -- evaluate Bhakti as a pathway to liberation -> state the criterion of a "pathway" (accessibility, sufficiency, terminus), then judge.
- 2020 Q8(c), 15 marks -- are Knowledge, Action and Devotion the means? -> name the disagreement; do NOT harmonise.

MEMORY: 15-mark means spine -> production vs removal + saksat vs arad-upakaraka -> Mimamsa (karma) / Sankara (jnana, rejects samuccaya) / Ramanuja (graded samuccaya -> bhakti) / Gita 5.4-5 convergence -> verdict on function vs terminus.

## Resurrection vs Rebirth vs Reincarnation; Inter-School Debates, Criticisms and Traps

### LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

- 2019 Q8(a), 20 marks -- Karma, Rebirth and Reincarnation -> the rebirth-vs-reincarnation cut is delivered here (substance vs wider term).
- 2020 Q5(b), 10 marks -- immortality as presupposition of religion -> the resurrection route + Cullmann's opposition.
- Feeds every "distinguish the terms" demand across the corpus.

MEMORY: 20-mark trio spine -> define karma, rebirth, reincarnation separately -> interlock them -> contrast resurrection (one life, divine act, Cullmann) -> identity objections BOTH ways -> verdict: neither term is a version of another.

### SOLVED PYQ BANK - EXACTLY 17 VERIFIED OWNER QUESTIONS

Exact wording, year and marks are parsed from the continuous local Philosophy of Religion Paper II bank for 2018-2025. This clause owns exactly 17 primary parts (2018:2, 2019:1, 2020:2, 2021:3, 2022:3, 2023:2, 2024:2, 2025:2). Ownership discipline: Indian Philosophy Paper I questions that merely mention moksha or soul are NOT counted here.

#### Solved PYQ 1 - 2018 Q5(b), 10 marks

**Question:** How far is it plausible to argue that the anti-theistic religions' stand on the concept of rebirth is philosophically significant?

#### Model solution

**Thesis.** The anti-theistic religions (Buddhism, and in its own way Jainism) are philosophically significant precisely because they show that rebirth is detachable both from a creator-God and from an immortal soul-substance.

- **Doctrine.** Buddhism affirms re-becoming (*punarbhava*) while denying a permanent self (*anatman*): what continues is a dependently arisen causal stream, not a transmigrating substance. Jainism has an eternal *jiva* but no God who administers karma; the moral law is self-regulating.

- **Significance (three claims).** (1) Karma needs no divine judge -- desert is discharged by an impersonal law, answering the problem of evil differently from theism. (2) Rebirth needs no immortal soul -- continuity, not substance, suffices (the flame-to-flame model). (3) Liberation (*nirvana*, *kevala*) requires neither grace nor union with God.

- **Objection -> reply.** If nothing permanent persists, who is reborn and who is liberated? Reply: the later stream is "neither the same nor wholly other"; moral responsibility rests on causal connectedness, not identity of substance.

**Verdict.** The stand is significant because it separates the *machinery* of karma-rebirth-liberation from theism and from soul-substance, proving that the Indian moral cosmos is not logically wedded to either.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it reads "significant" as a modal/structural claim (what rebirth does NOT require) rather than as praise, and names the exact anti-substantialist and anti-theistic points.

### Solved PYQ 2 - 2018 Q7(c), 15 marks

**Question:** Evaluate the concept of Bhakti (Devotion) as a pathway to attain liberation.

#### Model solution

**Thesis.** Bhakti is a complete path to liberation in the theistic Vedantas and a preparatory discipline in Advaita; its philosophical contribution is structural -- it relocates liberation from achievement to reception.

- **Define the criterion.** A "pathway" must be assessed for accessibility, sufficiency and terminus -- not merely described.
- **Textual base.** *Gita* 18.66 (*carama-sloka*: abandon all dharmas, take refuge in Me alone), 9.22 and 9.32 on accessibility; *Bhagavata* 7.5.23 lists the nine limbs (*navadha bhakti*): *sravana*, *kirtana*, *smarana*, *pada-sevana*, *arcana*, *vandana*, *dasya*, *sakhya*, *atma-nivedana*.
- **Typology (marks lie here).** *para* vs *apara*; *vaidhi* vs *raganuga*; *saguna* (Tulsidas, Mira) vs *nirguna* (Kabir, Nanak) -- the latter showing

bhakti needs a personal focus, not an iconic form.

- **Systematic positions.** Ramanuja: bhakti as *dhruvanusmrti*, with *prapatti* as the accessible alternative; grace decisive; *marjara* vs *markata* dispute on grace/effort. Madhva: *jnana-purvaka-sneha*. Caitanya: *prema* as a fifth *purusartha*. Advaita: bhakti is *citta-suddhi*, preparatory not liberating.

- **Objection -> reply.** Love presupposes duality, so bhakti cannot deliver Advaitic identity -> Advaita agrees and so classes it as means, not end; the theistic schools deny identity is the goal at all.

**Verdict.** Bhakti's significance is not emotional but structural: it makes moksa a matter of grace (reception) rather than qualification (achievement).

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- criterion-first evaluation, precise verse citation in order, the grace/effort dispute named, and the achievement-> reception thesis stated explicitly.

### Solved PYQ 3 - 2019 Q8(a), 20 marks

**Question:** State and explain the doctrines of Karma, Rebirth and Reincarnation in Hinduism.

#### Model solution

**Thesis.** Karma, rebirth and reincarnation are linked but non-identical: karma is the mechanism, rebirth the field, and "reincarnation" a school-specific substantialist reading that Buddhism refuses. Define each before expounding.

- **Karma.** Act together with its unseen potency (*adrsta/apurva*); classified as *sancita* (stored), *prarabdha* (ripening now) and *agami* (future). It is moral causation, not fatalism -- *purusakara* (effort) operates within *daiva*.
- **Rebirth.** *Punarjanma* within beginningless *samsara*; the subtle body (*suksma-sarira*) carries *samskaras* across lives. *Gita* 2.22 (worn-out

garments) and 9.21 (return from heaven when merit is exhausted) show even heaven is a within-*samsara* stage.

- **Reincarnation vs rebirth.** Reincarnation (*re-enfleshing*) presupposes a SUBSTANTIAL soul re-entering a body (Vedanta, Nyaya, Jainism). Rebirth is the wider, neutral term and the ONLY correct one for Buddhism's *punarbhava* without a transmigrating self.

- **Contrast.** Resurrection -- one life, divine re-constitution, final judgement (Cullmann's opposition of Greek immortality and Hebrew resurrection).

- **Criticism -> reply.** Memory objection and victim-blaming risk; reply -- memory is not continuity, and karma explains without licensing social blame.



**Verdict.** Karma supplies the mechanism, rebirth the field, and reincarnation a substantialist reading of that field which Buddhism rejects.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it obeys "state AND explain" by defining all three separately, then interlocking them, and it nails the reincarnation/rebirth distinction the question is built to test.

#### Solved PYQ 4 - 2020 Q5(b), 10 marks

**Question:** The concept of 'Immortality' is a basic presupposition of religion. Elaborate your answer.

#### Model solution

**Thesis.** Immortality functions as a basic presupposition of religion because most traditions require some post-mortem continuant to bear desert, judgement or liberation -- but the presupposition takes at least three different forms, and Buddhism shows it is not strictly necessary.

- **Why presupposed.** Moral seriousness (desert beyond this life), the hope of liberation/salvation, and the meaningfulness of ritual for the dead all seem to need something that survives death.

- **Three forms.** (1) Greek/Platonic natural immortality of a simple soul; (2) Semitic resurrection, where the psychosomatic person is re-constituted by God (not a natural property but a divine act -- Cullmann, 1955); (3) Indian eternal *atman/jiva* transmigrating until liberation.

- **The counter-example.** Buddhism grounds desert and liberation on a causal stream (*anatman*), so immortality is a common but not indispensable presupposition -- continuity is what is really required.

**Verdict.** "Immortality" is a widespread and structurally important presupposition of religion, but the deeper presupposition is CONTINUITY of a morally accountable subject, which Buddhism secures without an immortal soul.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it elaborates the claim (as asked) but refuses to overclaim, distinguishing the forms of the presupposition and citing the Buddhist limiting case.

#### Solved PYQ 5 - 2020 Q8(c), 15 marks

**Question:** Do you accept that Knowledge, Action and Devotion are the means to attain liberation in Indian tradition? Discuss.

#### Model solution

**Thesis.** Knowledge, action and devotion are all means to liberation, but means of DIFFERENT kinds; whether they are alternative, sequential or combined is settled by a prior question -- is liberation produced or uncovered?

- **Apparatus (deploy early).** Direct means (*saksat-sadhana*) vs remote aid (*arad-upakaraka*); means vs qualification (*adhikara*); production model vs

removal model of moksa.

- **Positions.** *Purva-Mimamsa*: karma alone (the *purvapaksa*). *Sankara*: jnana alone removes *avidya*; he rejects *jnana-karma-samuccaya*; karma and *upasana*

only purify (*sadhana-catustaya*; *sravana-manana-nididhyasana*). *Ramanuja*: karma -> jnana -> bhakti, with *prapatti* as the accessible alternative -- a graded *samuccaya*. *Madhva*: knowledge-grounded bhakti, *prasada* decisive.

- **The Gita's signal.** 5.4-5: only the immature call Samkhya (knowledge) and

Yoga (action) different -- which is why Sankara, Ramanuja and Tilak could each claim the text. Vivekananda's four yogas match temperament (psychological, not metaphysical, pluralism).

- **Objection -> reply.** "Convergence" is diplomatic mush -> reply: they converge in FUNCTION (removing egoic self-appropriation) but diverge in TERMINUS (identity vs communion); say this rather than harmonising.

**Verdict.** Karma qualifies, bhakti receives, jnana removes; their relation follows from each school's answer to whether liberation is produced or uncovered.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it names the disagreement instead of harmonising, and uses the production/removal cut to explain WHY schools differ.

**Solved PYQ 6 - 2021 Q6(a), 20 marks**

**Question:** Discuss the concept of immortality of soul with special reference to Hindu tradition.

**Model solution**

**Thesis.** In the Hindu tradition the immortality of the soul is affirmed across schools, but on different grounds and with different consequences for liberation; it is best read as the eternity of a continuity-bearer rather than one uniform doctrine.

- **Vedanta.** The *atman* is eternal and self-luminous; *Gita* 2.23 gives the canonical image that weapons, fire, water and wind cannot destroy the embodied self. Advaita: *atman* = Brahman; Visistadvaita: the *jiva* is an eternal mode of God.

- **Nyaya-Vaisesika.** The self is an eternal substance, but consciousness is adventitious to it -- hence *apavarga* is cessation of pain and of consciousness.

- **Samkhya-Yoga.** *Purusa* is eternal, plural, contentless witness, isolated by nature (*kevala*).

- **Comparison with the West.** Plato argues immortality a priori (Phaedo); the Hindu case rests on scriptural testimony and substance-metaphysics, not on the Forms.

- **Critique -> reply.** The soul's simplicity does not entail indestructibility (Kant's paralogism), and there is no memory of past lives -> reply: continuity is carried by *samskaras* in the subtle body, distinct from psychological memory.

**Verdict.** Hindu "immortality of the soul" is the eternity of a continuity- bearer (*atman/jiva/purusa*), variously conceived, and it grounds -- but does not by itself deliver -- liberation.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it keeps "Hindu tradition" plural (Vedanta, Nyaya, Samkhya) instead of collapsing it, and cites the verified Gita 2.23 image.

### Solved PYQ 7 - 2021 Q6(b), 15 marks

**Question:** Elucidate the concept of liberation according to Advaita Vedānta. Explain the role of knowledge in the attainment of liberation.

#### Model solution

**Thesis.** For Advaita, liberation (*moksa*) is the realisation of the *atman*'s identity with Brahman through the removal of ignorance (*avidya*); knowledge (*jnana*) is therefore the sole direct means.

- **Nature of liberation.** *Moksa* is not a producible effect but the eternally accomplished nature of the self, obscured by *avidya*. It comes as *jivanmukti*

(freedom while living, the body coasting on *prarabdha* like a spun wheel) and *videhamukti* (at the body's fall).

- **Role of knowledge.** Since bondage is ignorance, only knowledge can remove it, as light removes darkness. Sankara rejects *jnana-karma-samuccaya*; action and *upasana* generate *citta-suddhi* and the *sadhana-catustaya*, and knowledge matures through *sravana-manana-nididhyasana*.

- **Provenance (Griffiths).** Bondage is a beginningless superimposition (*adhyasa*) -- the rope taken for a snake -- so *moksa* is "not acquired but acknowledged"; knowledge only removes the error.

- **Objection -> reply.** If knowledge destroys karma, why does the body remain?  
-> already-fructifying *prarabdha* is distinguished from accumulated and future karma.

**Verdict.** Advaitic liberation is a cognitive-existential awakening, and knowledge is the direct means because liberation is uncovered, not produced.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it answers BOTH obligations (the concept AND the role of knowledge), and grounds the "knowledge alone" claim in the removal model.

### Solved PYQ 8 - 2021 Q8(b), 15 marks

**Question:** Discuss and evaluate the doctrine of Karma as an essential postulate of Hinduism.

#### Model solution

**Thesis.** The doctrine of karma is an essential postulate of Hinduism because it supplies a self-regulating moral order that makes rebirth intelligible and desert just; it is defensible against fatalism and moral-luck objections but remains empirically unverifiable.

- **Statement.** Every morally qualified act leaves an unseen potency (*adrsta/apurva*) that matures as pleasure or pain; *sancita/prarabdha/agami* classify the debt. Karma requires rebirth, since fruits mature beyond one life.

- **Why a postulate.** It grounds moral responsibility, explains the distribution of fortune without a capricious deity, and secures the justice of *samsara*.

- **Evaluation.** Strength -- it is not fatalism: *purusakara* operates within *daiva*; present effort shapes *agami*.  
Weakness -- unverifiability, and the moral-luck/victim-blaming risk.

- **Objection -> reply.** Karma blames the sufferer -> reply: it EXPLAINS distribution without LICENSING social judgement; compassion remains obligatory.

**Verdict.** Karma is postulated because it does indispensable work -- justice, responsibility, the intelligibility of rebirth -- but its warrant is inferential and moral, not empirical.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it both expounds AND evaluates (as asked), defending karma against fatalism while conceding unverifiability.

### Solved PYQ 9 - 2022 Q5(c), 10 marks

**Question:** "Immortality of Soul is a necessary postulate for rebirth." Critically examine with reference to Buddhism.

#### Model solution

**Thesis.** The claim that immortality of the soul is a necessary postulate for rebirth is false as stated: a persisting soul is SUFFICIENT for rebirth but not NECESSARY, and Buddhism is the decisive counter-example.

- **The substantialist assumption.** In Vedanta, Nyaya and Jainism an eternal *atman/jiva* is exactly what transmigrates, so there immortality is presupposed.

- **The Buddhist refutation.** Buddhism denies a permanent self (*anatman*) yet affirms rebirth (*punarbhava*): what continues is a dependently arisen causal stream, illustrated by a flame passing candle to candle. Rebirth therefore requires CONTINUITY, not an unchanging substance.

- **Objection -> reply.** If no same agent persists, who is reborn and who reaps the fruit? -> the later stream is "neither the same nor wholly other"; moral responsibility rests on causal connectedness.

**Verdict.** Immortality of a substantial soul is sufficient but not necessary for rebirth; what rebirth strictly needs is a continuity-bearer, and schools disagree only about whether that bearer must be a substance. Buddhism proves the point.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it delivers a precise MODAL verdict (sufficient not necessary) and uses Buddhism as a counter-example, not merely an exception.

### Solved PYQ 10 - 2022 Q7(b), 15 marks

**Question:** Is it possible to have an idea of Liberation without the conception of a real agent? In this context, discuss the difference between Advaita and Viśiṣṭādvaita systems of thought.

#### Model solution

**Thesis.** An idea of liberation without a "real agent" is coherent, and the Advaita-Visistadvaita dispute is exactly a dispute over whether the liberated subject is an ultimately real individual agent.

- **The paradox.** If Advaita denies ultimate individuality, who is bound and who is liberated?

- **Advaita.** *Moksa* is the sublation of a MISTAKEN individuality, not the annihilation of an entity; conventional agency (*vyavaharika*) operates until liberating knowledge removes the misidentification. The "agent" is real empirically, unreal absolutely -- so liberation needs no ultimately real agent.

- **Visistadvaita.** The *jiva* is a real, eternal mode of God, a genuine agent throughout, bound by karma and freed into communion/service; it never becomes God. So it faces no agent-paradox but pays with irreducible plurality.

- **Objection -> reply.** Advaita's conventional agency looks ad hoc -> reply: the two-truths framework is doing principled work, distinguishing the standpoint of ignorance from that of realisation.

**Verdict.** Liberation without a real (ultimate) agent is coherent on Advaita and denied on Visistadvaita; the difference is not about liberation's possibility but about the ontological status of the one who is free.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it reframes the "real agent" question as the very axis dividing the two schools, giving each its own answer rather than blending.

### Solved PYQ 11 - 2022 Q8(b), 15 marks

**Question:** Discuss the nature of Soul and Bondage according to Jainism.

#### Model solution

**Thesis.** In Jainism the soul (*jiva*) is an eternal, conscious substance whose bondage is the literal adhesion of fine karmic MATTER; liberation is the complete stoppage and shedding of that matter.

- **Nature of the soul.** Every living being is an eternal conscious *jiva*, of the size of the body it occupies, whose intrinsic nature is infinite knowledge, perception, bliss and energy (*ananta-catustaya*), currently obscured.
- **Bondage machinery.** Passions and action ATTRACT karmic particles (*asrava*); they BIND to the soul (*bandha*); restraint STOPS the influx (*samvara*); austerity SHEDS accumulated karma (*nirjara*); the freed *jiva* manifests its full qualities and rises to the summit of the universe (*siddhatva*).
- **Distinction.** Jain liberation PERFECTS individuality -- neither Advaitic identity nor Buddhist cessation without a self. Jain *kevala* = omniscience, not Samkhya's contentless *kaivalya*.
- **Objection -> reply.** How does non-material consciousness interact with quasi-material karma? -> Jainism treats extension and embodiment as MODES of the *jiva* during bondage; the reply is contested but internally consistent.

**Verdict.** The Jain soul is eternal and intrinsically omniscient, and bondage/ liberation are a quasi-physical process of accretion and removal of karmic matter.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it delivers BOTH nouns the question names (soul AND bondage), with the *asrava-bandha-samvara-nirjara* machinery in order.

### Solved PYQ 12 - 2023 Q6(a), 20 marks

**Question:** Critically examine Plato's apriori proofs for the immortality of the soul.

#### Model solution

**Thesis.** Plato's four Phaedo arguments make the soul's immortality suggestive but not demonstrable; assessed separately, each either reaches only pre-existence or rests on an undefended assumption.

- **(1) Opposites (cyclical).** Living and dead arise from each other, so souls persist between lives. *Assessment:* establishes recurrence, not the soul's indestructibility; the analogy from physical opposites is weak.
- **(2) Recollection (anamnesis).** We judge equal sticks by an Equality never perfectly given in sense, so the soul knew it before birth. *Assessment:* proves (at most) PRE-existence, not post-mortem survival.
- **(3) Affinity.** The soul is simple, invisible and akin to the Forms, so it does not decompose. *Assessment:* likeness is not identity; simplicity does not entail indestructibility.
- **(4) Form of Life.** The soul essentially brings Life and cannot admit its opposite, death. *Assessment:* the strongest, but it assumes the soul is essentially life-giving -- the point at issue.
- **Objection -> reply.** Simmias' harmony analogy makes the soul a bodily attunement -> Plato replies the soul RULES the body and pre-exists it.
- **External critique.** Kant's paralogism: the soul is not a knowable substance.

**Verdict.** The arguments are mutually supporting rather than individually conclusive; they render immortality intelligible, not proven.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- "critically examine" is obeyed by FOUR separate assessments plus Simmias and Kant, not one summary verdict.

### Solved PYQ 13 - 2023 Q7(b), 15 marks

**Question:** Examine the significance of the concept of rebirth in the theory of Karma.

#### Model solution

**Thesis.** Rebirth is not an optional appendage to the theory of karma but its enabling condition: without further lives, karma's justice -- fruits maturing beyond a single lifetime -- would be impossible.

- **The link.** Karma is act plus unseen potency (*adrsta/apurva*); much of it (*sancita, agami*) matures only in future lives. Rebirth is the FIELD in which

those fruits ripen, so karmic desert requires a continued series.

- **Continuity-bearer.** In substantial systems the subtle body carries *samskaras* across births; in Buddhism a causal stream does the same work without a soul -- showing rebirth needs continuity, not necessarily substance.

- **Scriptural note.** *Gita* 9.21: those who exhaust their merit "return to the world of mortals" -- even heaven is a within-*samsara* stage, confirming that desert keeps the wheel turning.

- **Objection -> reply.** Rebirth is unverifiable and morally hazardous -> reply: untestability is shared with resurrection, and explanatory karma does not license blaming the sufferer.

**Verdict.** Rebirth is significant in karma theory as the mechanism of discharge: it is what makes moral desert coherent when one life is too short to settle it.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it explains the FUNCTION of rebirth within karma (discharge of desert), not just the fact of it, and adds the continuity point.

### Solved PYQ 14 - 2024 Q5(c), 10 marks

**Question:** Discuss the concept of liberation (*Apavarga*) according to Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika.

#### Model solution

**Thesis.** For Nyaya-Vaisesika, liberation (*apavarga*) is the absolute cessation of pain together with the qualities -- including consciousness -- that sustain embodied experience; it is a negative state, not positive bliss.

- **The suffering-chain.** Suffering arises through false knowledge -> defect -> activity -> rebirth -> suffering; true knowledge (*tattva-jnana*) reverses the chain from its root.

- **What liberation is.** The self is an eternal substance to which consciousness is ADVENTITIOUS (arising only through contact with mind and body). In *apavarga* the self persists, but stripped of the nine special qualities including cognition, pleasure and pain -- hence liberation is the end of experience, not its perfection.

- **Distinction.** *Apavarga* differs from positive heavenly pleasure, and from Advaita's blissful *moksa*; it resembles cessation more than fulfilment.

- **Objection -> reply.** A consciousness-less liberation seems undesirable -> reply: Nyaya honestly offers freedom from pain, not a reward; to promise bliss would misdescribe the self.

**Verdict.** *Apavarga* is the cessation of pain and of the very consciousness that makes pain possible -- the sharpest Indian statement of liberation as release rather than beatitude.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it refuses to sentimentalise *apavarga* as bliss, grounding "no consciousness" in the adventitious-consciousness doctrine.

### Solved PYQ 15 - 2024 Q6(a), 20 marks

**Question:** Is it necessary to adhere to the notions of immortality of soul and rebirth in order to have a robust conception of liberation? Give reasons and justifications for your answer.

#### Model solution

**Thesis.** A robust conception of liberation requires a continuity-bearer that can be bound across lives and then freed -- but it does NOT require an immortal soul-substance; Buddhism shows liberation is coherent on a causal-continuity model.

- **The apparent necessity.** Liberation is exit from bondage-across-lives, so it seems to presuppose (a) rebirth, and (b) something immortal that is liberated. Vedanta, Nyaya and Jainism satisfy both with an eternal *atman/jiva*.
- **The Buddhist case.** *Anatman* + *pratityasamutpada* deliver rebirth and *nirvana* with no permanent self: the stream that was bound is the stream that ceases to crave. So "immortality of soul" is sufficient, not necessary.
- **What IS necessary.** A continuity that can carry desert and then END. Call it substance (substantialists) or stream (Buddhism); either grounds a robust liberation.
- **Objection -> reply.** Without an immortal self, liberation liberates no one -> reply: it liberates the causal series from craving; identity of substance is not required for the coherence of release.

**Verdict.** Immortality and rebirth are the standard scaffolding of liberation but not its logical minimum; the minimum is a morally continuous subject whose bondage can cease -- which Buddhism secures without an eternal soul.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it gives reasons BOTH ways (as the stem demands), then fixes the exact modal minimum, using Buddhism as the load-bearing case.

### Solved PYQ 16 - 2025 Q5(d), 10 marks

**Question:** Discuss the nature of embodied liberation (*jīvanmukti*) with reference to Advaita Vedānta.

#### Model solution

**Thesis.** *Jīvanmukti* in Advaita Vedānta is liberation WHILE EMBODIED: the knower of Brahman is free the moment ignorance is destroyed, though the body continues on residual momentum until death.

- **The doctrine.** *Moksha* is realising *atman* = Brahman by ending *avidya*. Since bondage is ignorance, liberating knowledge frees IMMEDIATELY -- one need not wait for death.
- **Why the body remains.** Already-fructifying *prarabdha* karma sustains the body, like a potter's wheel that spins on after the hand is withdrawn; accumulated (*sancita*) and future (*agami*) karma are burnt by knowledge. *Videhamukti* follows at the body's fall.
- **Character of the jīvanmukta.** Free from egoic appropriation, acting without binding karma, established in Brahman-consciousness now.
- **Objection -> reply.** If knowledge destroys karma, why any embodiment at all? -> the distinction of *prarabdha* from *sancita/agami* answers exactly this.

**Verdict.** *Jīvanmukti* shows Advaitic liberation is a present cognitive- existential transformation, not a post-mortem place or reward -- freedom is realised, not relocated.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it fixes *jīvanmukti* against *videhamukti* and > explains the residual body by *prarabdha*, the exact discriminator examiners want.



### Solved PYQ 17 - 2025 Q7(c), 15 marks

**Question:** Is the concept of immortality of soul a necessary condition for Rebirth? Discuss with reference to the Bhagavad Gītā.

#### Model solution

**Thesis.** With reference to the *Bhagavad Gita*, immortality of the soul is presented as the presupposition of rebirth: precisely because the embodied self is imperishable, it "casts off worn-out bodies and enters new ones". Yet, read philosophically, this shows immortality is sufficient for rebirth, not universally necessary.

- **The Gita's teaching.** 2.23 -- weapons, fire, water and wind cannot destroy the self; 2.22 -- the self changes bodies as a person changes worn-out garments. Rebirth here PRESUPPOSES the deathless *atman*.

- **The mechanism.** Driven by karma, the imperishable self takes new embodiments within *samsara*; 9.21 shows even heavenly sojourn ends in return.

- **The wider verdict.** The Gita's model is substantialist, so for IT immortality is necessary. But Buddhism affirms rebirth without an immortal soul, so the necessity is school-relative: the Gita states a sufficient condition, not a law binding every rebirth theory.

- **Objection -> reply.** Does the Gita PROVE immortality? -> No; it ASSERTS it as scriptural teaching and illustrates it (the garment image is illustration, not demonstration).

**Verdict.** In the Gita, immortality of the soul is the necessary ground of rebirth; across the traditions, it is sufficient but not necessary -- Buddhism is the reservation the honest answer records.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it stays faithful to the NAMED text (Gita verses) while still delivering the modal verdict and the Buddhist reservation.

Three original questions authored for this package (not PYQs), one each at 10, 15 and 20 marks, with full model solutions.

### ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

#### Original Mains 1

Original question | Philosophy Paper II, Philosophy of Religion | 10 marks | answer in ~150 words

**Question:** Distinguish rebirth from reincarnation, and explain why the distinction is decisive for Buddhism.

#### Model solution

**Thesis.** Rebirth is the wider, more neutral term; reincarnation is the narrower term that assumes a substantial soul re-entering flesh -- which is why Buddhism accepts rebirth but not reincarnation.

- **Reincarnation** (*re-enfleshing*) presupposes an enduring soul-substance that passes from body to body; it fits Vedanta, Nyaya and Jainism.

- **Rebirth** (*punarjanma/punarbhava*) names only re-becoming within *samsara*, and can be cashed out with or without a substance.

- **Why decisive for Buddhism.** Buddhism affirms *punarbhava* while denying a permanent self (*anatman*); what continues is a dependently arisen causal stream (flame-to-flame), "neither the same nor wholly other". To call this "reincarnation" would smuggle back the very soul-substance Buddhism denies.

**Verdict.** Use "rebirth" as the genus and reserve "reincarnation" for the substantialist species; only then is Buddhist *punarbhava* correctly described.



## Original Mains 2

Original question | Philosophy Paper II, Philosophy of Religion | 15 marks | answer in ~250 words

**Question:** Examine whether 'liberation' can be treated as a single concept across the Indian schools.

### Model solution

**Thesis.** 'Liberation' is a family-resemblance term, not a single concept: once the school-specific destinations are separated, the apparent Indian consensus turns out to be a shared vocabulary covering incompatible states.

- **The parity bench.** *Moksa* (Advaita) is realised identity with Brahman; *moksa* (Visistadvaita) is eternal communion with God; *apavarga* (Nyaya) is cessation of pain AND of consciousness; *kaivalya* (Samkhya-Yoga) is the isolation of contentless consciousness; *kevala/siddhatva* (Jain) is perfected omniscient individuality; *nirvana* (Buddhism) is the cessation of craving with

no self affirmed.

- **The consciousness test.** These states differ precisely on what survives:

Nyaya keeps a self but no consciousness; Advaita keeps non-dual bliss; Samkhya keeps contentless awareness; Jainism keeps omniscience; Buddhism affirms no self. A single concept cannot span "no consciousness" and "infinite bliss".

- **What they share.** Only a formal core: cessation of bondage and exit from *samsara*. That is a family resemblance, not a common essence.

- **Objection -> reply.** Perhaps all are "freedom from suffering"? Reply: even this masks a production/removal split and the identity/isolation divide.

**Verdict.** Treat 'liberation' as a genus with irreducibly different species; fixing the exact term against the parity bench is the first task in any answer.

## Original Mains 3

Original question | Philosophy Paper II, Philosophy of Religion | 20 marks | answer in ~400 words

**Question:** Compare the Western resurrection tradition and the Indian rebirth tradition on the problem of personal identity across death.

### Model solution

**Thesis.** Resurrection and rebirth answer different questions and face the identity problem from opposite directions; neither is a version of the other, and on both the question "is the later being the SAME?" remains unresolved.

- **Two structures.** Resurrection (Hebrew-Christian-Islamic) is ONE life: the person is a psychosomatic unity, so survival needs God to re-constitute the whole person, and history ends in judgement. Rebirth (Indian) is a beginningless series in which karma matures across lives until liberation. Oscar Cullmann (1955) argues Greek immortality and Hebrew resurrection are theologically OPPOSED, not complementary.

- **Identity for resurrection.** The gap problem (what exists between death and resurrection?) and the re-assembly ("cannibal") problem (shared atoms) threaten bodily continuity. Standard replies: Aquinas -- the rational soul is the FORM of the body and secures continuity; van Inwagen -- God preserves a core of the body or leaves a simulacrum; Hick -- an exact, unique psychophysical replica, continuous in memory and character, is the same person for all that matters. The duplication objection (God could make two) says the criterion is then not identity.

- **Book support.** Lynne Rudder Baker ("Death and the Afterlife", Oxford Handbook of Philosophy of Religion) sets out four candidate criteria -- same soul, same body, same composite, or continuity of memory -- and surveys Origen's "seed", Augustine's re-collected "statue" and Aquinas's soul-as-form; Bernard Williams's reduplication argument and H. H. Price's image-world sharpen the difficulty.

- **Identity for rebirth.** The memory objection (no recollection of prior lives)

is met by distinguishing psychological memory from metaphysical continuity and appealing to latent *samskaras*; in Buddhism identity is dropped altogether in favour of a causal stream "neither the same nor wholly other".

- **Contrast.** Resurrection keeps the body essential; rebirth discards it like a garment (*Gīta* 2.22). Resurrection needs a divine agent; rebirth needs only the self-regulating law of karma.

**Verdict.** Resurrection asks how an essentially embodied person can survive; rebirth asks how moral desert can be discharged when one life is too short. Both leave the sameness of the later being contested -- for resurrection because of the gap and duplication, for rebirth because of the missing memory and (in Buddhism) the deliberate abandonment of numerical identity.

## CANONICAL EXAM APPARATUS (PRESERVED VERBATIM)

The examiner apparatus below is reproduced verbatim from the canonical Soul-Immortality-Rebirth.md (headings demoted, navigation links stripped). It is preserved intact so that no canonical depth - foundational statement bank, applied-question drills, PYQ-mapped model-answer skeletons, the keyword and statement bank, the corpus depth delta, PYQ routing, answer architecture, directive decoder, graded verdict ladder, factual / quotation discipline, link-outs and sources - is lost in the layered reorganisation.

### Foundational Statement Bank

1. FACT: *Bhagavad Gītā* 2.23 presents the self as not destructible by weapons or elements; translations vary.
2. FACT: Plato's recollection argument infers pre-existence from knowledge not exhausted by deficient sensible instances.
3. FACT: Flame-to-flame is a standard illustration of Buddhist causal continuity without numerical identity.
4. FACT: *Jīvanmukti* means liberation while embodied life continues.
5. FACT: Nyāya apavarga is final cessation of suffering and the qualities that sustain embodied experience.

### Applied-Question Drills

1. **[Plato]** "Critically examine Plato's a priori proofs for immortality." (2023, 20m) -> §1. 2. **[Buddhism]** "Immortality of soul is necessary for rebirth." Examine w.r.t. Buddhism." (2022) -> §2. 3. **[Nyāya]** "Concept of liberation (apavarga) in Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika." (2024) -> §3. 4. **[Advaita]** "Nature of jīvanmukti in Advaita Vedānta." (2025) -> §3. 5. **[Necessity]** "Is immortality+rebirth necessary for a robust conception of liberation?" (2024) -> §2-3. 6. **[Bhakti]** "Evaluate Bhakti as a pathway to liberation." (2018, 15m) -> §8.6. 7. **[Three means]** "Are Knowledge, Action and Devotion the means to liberation?" (2020, 15m) -> §8.7 - name the disagreement, do not harmonise. 8. **[Karma trio]** "Karma, Rebirth and Reincarnation in Hinduism." (2019, 20m) -> §8.8 - **distinguish rebirth from reincarnation explicitly**. 9. **[Immortality presupposition]** "Immortality' is a basic presupposition of religion." (2020, 10m) -> §1 + §8.8 (resurrection route + Buddhist counter-example). 10. **[Agent]** "Liberation without a real agent? Advaita vs Viśiṣṭādvaita." (2022, 15m) -> §8.2 + §8.7 apparatus. 11. **[Kaivalya]** "Sāṃkhya-Yoga's conception of liberation." -> §8.9 - isolation, not identity or bliss.

### PYQ-Mapped Model-Answer Skeletons

#### 6.1 - "Is immortality of the soul a necessary condition for rebirth? (w.r.t. Buddhism)" (2022, 10m)

Intro : substantialist assumption - a soul must persist to transmigrate.

Body : Vedānta/Nyāya/Jain - YES, eternal ātman/jīva is what is reborn;  
Buddhism - NO: anātman; what continues is a causal stream (pratītyasamutpāda), rebirth like flame-to-flame, not a soul.

Assess: rebirth needs CONTINUITY, not necessarily an unchanging soul.

Concl : immortality is sufficient but not necessary - Buddhism proves the point.

## 6.2 - "Nature of jīvanmukti in Advaita Vedānta." (2025, 10m)

Intro : Advaita - mokṣa is realising ātman = Brahman; ends avidyā.  
Body : jīvanmukti = liberated WHILE living; jñāna destroys ignorance now;  
body persists by prārabdha karma (spun-wheel) -> videhamukti at death.  
Assess: liberation is a cognitive-existential transformation, not a post-mortem reward.  
Concl : freedom is present realisation, not a future place.

## 6.3 - "Evaluate the concept of Bhakti (Devotion) as a pathway to attain liberation." (2018, 15m)

Intro : bhakti = loving devotion to a personal God, held to be a DIRECT means of mokṣa.  
Body : textual base - Gītā 18.66 (carama-śloka), 9.22; Bhāgavata 7.5.23 navadhā bhakti;  
Nārada/Śaṇḍilya Bhakti Sūtras.  
typology - parā/aparā; vaidhī/rāgānugā; saguṇa (Tulsidās, Mīrā) vs nirguṇa (Kabīr, Nānak).  
systematic - Rāmānuja (dhruvānusr̥ṭi + prapatti; grace); mārjāra vs markāṭa nyāya;  
Madhva (jñāna-pūrvaka-sneha); Vallabha (puṣṭi); Caitanya (prema as fifth puruṣārtha);  
Advaita (preparatory - citta-śuddhi, not direct means).  
Assess: strengths - accessibility across caste/gender/language; whole-person engagement;  
grace answers the incapacity of a beginninglessly bound jīva.  
objections - love presupposes duality; emotionalism; grace vs effort; requires a  
personal God.  
Concl : philosophically, bhakti relocates liberation from achievement to RECEPTION - that, not  
emotion, is its contribution.

## 6.4 - "Are Knowledge, Action and Devotion the means to liberation in Indian tradition?" (2020, 15m)

Intro : the real question is whether they are alternative, sequential or combined.  
Tools : sākṣāt-sādhana vs ārād-upakāraka; means vs adhikāra; PRODUCTION vs REMOVAL model of mokṣa.  
Body : Mīmāṃsā - karma alone (the pūrvapakṣa).  
Śaṅkara - jñāna alone removes avidyā; rejects jñāna-karma-samuccaya; karma/upāsana only  
purify (sādhana-catuṣṭaya; śravaṇa-manana-nididhyāsana).  
Rāmānuja - karma -> jñāna -> bhakti, with prapatti as the accessible alternative.  
Madhva - knowledge-grounded bhakti; prasāda decisive.  
Gītā 5.4-5 - only the immature call Sāṃkhya and Yoga different; hence Śaṅkara, Rāmānuja  
and Tilak could each claim the text.  
Vivekananda - four yogas matched to temperament (psychological, not metaphysical,  
pluralism).  
Assess: they converge in FUNCTION (dismantling egoic appropriation) and diverge in TERMINUS  
(identity vs communion) - say this rather than harmonising.  
Concl : all three are means, of different kinds - karma qualifies, bhakti receives, jñāna removes.

## 6.5 - "Karma, Rebirth and Reincarnation in Hinduism." (2019, 20m)

Intro : three linked but non-identical concepts - define each before expounding.  
B1 : Karma - act + its unseen potency (adṛṣṭa/apūrva); sañcita / prārabdha / āgāmi;  
moral causation, not fatalism (puruṣakāra vs daiva).  
B2 : Rebirth - punarjanma within beginningless saṃsāra; subtle body carries saṃskāras;  
Gītā 2.22 (garments) and 9.21 (return from heaven when merit is exhausted).  
B3 : Reincarnation vs rebirth - reincarnation presupposes a SUBSTANTIAL soul re-enfleshed  
(Vedānta, Nyāya, Jainism); rebirth is the wider term and the only correct one for  
Buddhism's punarbhava without a transmigrating self.  
Contrast: resurrection - one life, divine re-constitution, final judgement (Cullmann's opposition  
of Greek immortality and Hebrew resurrection).  
Crit : memory objection; unverifiability; victim-blaming risk - and the replies.  
Concl : karma supplies the mechanism, rebirth the field, and "reincarnation" a school-specific  
substantialist reading that Buddhism refuses.

## Keyword and Statement Bank

**Keywords:** FACT: immortality · pre-existence · recollection · affinity · Form of Life · resurrection · psychosomatic unity  
· replica theory · gap problem · re-assembly objection · ātman · jīva · subtle body (*sūkṣma/linga-śarīra*) · karma ·  
saṃsāra · *punarjanma* · *punarbhava* · reincarnation vs rebirth · *anātman* · causal continuum · *pratīyasamutpāda* ·  
*saṃskāra/vāsanā* · apavarga · mokṣa · nirvāṇa · kaivalya · *kevala-jñāna* · *jīvanmukti* · *videhamukti* · *videha-kaivalya* ·  
*prārabdha* · *saṃvara* · *nirjarā* · bhakti · *navadhā bhakti* · *vaidhī/rāgānugā* · saguṇa/nirguṇa bhakti · *prapatti/śaraṇāgati* ·  
*mārjāra/markāṭa-nyāya* · *puṣṭi-mārga* · *prema-bhakti* · *citta-śuddhi* · *upāsana* · *sādhana-catuṣṭaya* ·  
*śravaṇa-manana-nididhyāsana* · *jñāna-karma-samuccaya* · *sākṣāt-sādhana/ārād-upakāraka* · *niṣkāma-karma* ·  
*aviveka* · *viveka-khyāti* · *satkāryavāda* · threefold *duḥkha* · *citta-vṛtti-nirodha* · *kleśa* · *aṣṭāṅga* ·  
*dharma-megha-samādhi* · *pratiprasava* · *citi-śakti* · *Īśvara-praṇidhāna*.

**Safe formulations:** ANALYSIS: "Rebirth requires an account of continuity, not necessarily an immortal substance."  
"Liberation is a family-resemblance term: cessation, isolation, identity-realisation and perfected individuality must not

be conflated." · "Karma qualifies, bhakti receives, jñāna removes - the dispute over their relation is really a dispute over whether liberation is produced or uncovered." · "Resurrection and rebirth answer different questions; neither is a version of the other."

### Corpus-Driven Depth Delta

- ANALYSIS: **Priority:** This is the largest Religion owner: 17 of 112 parts across 2018-2025.
- FACT: **Required doctrinal depth:** Older papers add anti-theistic rebirth, bhakti as liberation-path, karma-rebirth-reincarnation, immortality as religious presupposition, Hindu soul and Advaitic liberation, and jñāna-karma-bhakti comparison.
- WRONG: **Trap / answer consequence:** Do not make a permanent soul logically necessary for every rebirth theory; distinguish continuity, reincarnation, resurrection, liberation and the metaphysics of the agent.

### PYQ Routing Table (2018-2025)

ANALYSIS: **Corpus signal:** 17 primary-owned question-parts out of 112. The local Paper II corpus is continuous from 2018 through 2025. Cross-links do not create duplicate ownership.

| Year | Question | Marks    | Exact demand                                                                                                                                                                       |
|------|----------|----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2018 | Q5(b)    | 10 marks | How far is it plausible to argue that the anti-theistic religions' stand on the concept of rebirth is philosophically significant?                                                 |
| 2018 | Q7(c)    | 15 marks | Evaluate the concept of Bhakti (Devotion) as a pathway to attain liberation.                                                                                                       |
| 2019 | Q8(a)    | 20 marks | State and explain the doctrines of Karma, Rebirth and Reincarnation in Hinduism.                                                                                                   |
| 2020 | Q5(b)    | 10 marks | The concept of 'Immortality' is a basic presupposition of religion. Elaborate your answer.                                                                                         |
| 2020 | Q8(c)    | 15 marks | Do you accept that Knowledge, Action and Devotion are the means to attain liberation in Indian tradition? Discuss.                                                                 |
| 2021 | Q6(a)    | 20 marks | Discuss the concept of immortality of soul with special reference to Hindu tradition.                                                                                              |
| 2021 | Q6(b)    | 15 marks | Elucidate the concept of liberation according to Advaita Vedānta. Explain the role of knowledge in the attainment of liberation.                                                   |
| 2021 | Q8(b)    | 15 marks | Discuss and evaluate the doctrine of Karma as an essential postulate of Hinduism.                                                                                                  |
| 2022 | Q5(c)    | 10 marks | "Immortality of Soul is a necessary postulate for rebirth." Critically examine with reference to Buddhism.                                                                         |
| 2022 | Q7(b)    | 15 marks | Is it possible to have an idea of Liberation without the conception of a real agent? In this context, discuss the difference between Advaita and Viśiṣṭādvaita systems of thought. |
| 2022 | Q8(b)    | 15 marks | Discuss the nature of Soul and Bondage according to Jainism.                                                                                                                       |
| 2023 | Q6(a)    | 20 marks | Critically examine Plato's apriori proofs for the immortality of the soul.                                                                                                         |
| 2023 | Q7(b)    | 15 marks | Examine the significance of the concept of rebirth in the theory of Karma.                                                                                                         |
| 2024 | Q5(c)    | 10 marks | Discuss the concept of liberation (Apavarga) according to Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika.                                                                                                         |
| 2024 | Q6(a)    | 20 marks | Is it necessary to adhere to the notions of immortality of soul and rebirth in order to have a robust conception of liberation? Give reasons and justifications for your answer.   |
| 2025 | Q5(d)    | 10 marks | Discuss the nature of embodied liberation (jīvanmukti) with reference to Advaita Vedānta.                                                                                          |
| 2025 | Q7(c)    | 15 marks | Is the concept of immortality of soul a necessary condition for Rebirth? Discuss with reference to the Bhagavad Gītā.                                                              |

See the Philosophy of Religion PYQ Bank, 2018-2025.

## Answer Architecture (10 / 15 / 20 Marks)

### 10 marks

Define the disputed necessity -> give substantialist position -> Buddhist/Jain/Nyāya discriminator as required -> objection -> precise verdict on necessary vs sufficient.

### 15 marks

State doctrine and continuity-bearer -> causal sequence -> canonical example -> nearest school contrast -> objection/reply -> identify exact conception of liberation.

### 20 marks

Separate immortality, rebirth and liberation -> reconstruct two rival models -> personal-identity and moral-responsibility objections -> school replies -> graded conclusion on continuity without conflation.

### Directive Decoder

| Directive                                           | Examiner is buying                                 | Structural consequence                                                                       | Live example                               |
|-----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| Is X a necessary condition for Y?                   | A modal verdict - necessary / sufficient / neither | Give the substantialist "yes", then the Buddhist counter-example, then the exact modal claim | 2022 Q5(c); 2025 Q7(c); 2024 Q6(a)         |
| Discuss with reference to [named text/school]       | Fidelity to <i>that</i> source                     | The Gītā question must cite Gītā verses, not generic Vedānta                                 | 2025 Q7(c) w.r.t. <i>the Bhagavad Gītā</i> |
| Critically examine [thinker]'s proofs               | Each argument separately assessed                  | Four Platonic arguments = four mini-assessments, not one summary                             | 2023 Q6(a) Plato                           |
| Elucidate... and explain the role of...             | Two obligations - obey both                        | Half the answer on the concept, half on the specified role                                   | 2021 Q6(b) liberation + role of knowledge  |
| Do you accept that...? Discuss                      | An explicit acceptance/rejection with reasons      | Position first; then evidence; then the strongest contrary case                              | 2020 Q8(c) knowledge/action/devotion       |
| Evaluate the concept of X as a pathway              | Assessment of <i>efficacy</i> , not description    | State the criterion of a "pathway" - accessibility, sufficiency, terminus                    | 2018 Q7(c) bhakti                          |
| State and explain the doctrines of A, B and C       | Three defined doctrines and their <i>relations</i> | Define each separately, then show how they interlock                                         | 2019 Q8(a) karma/rebirth/reincarnation     |
| Discuss the nature of A and B according to [school] | Two nouns, both delivered                          | Jain "soul <b>and</b> bondage" needs <i>jīva</i> metaphysics <b>and</b> <i>āsrava/bandha</i> | 2022 Q8(b)                                 |

MEMORY: **Rule:** the moment a question names a **term of liberation** (mokṣa/apavarga/kaivalya/nirvāṇa/jīvanmukti), your first job is to fix that term against the §5A bench. Half the marks in this clause are lost to term-merging.

## Graded Verdict Ladder

| Band                    | What the script contains                                                                                                                                                                                    | Typical fault                                                                       |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Weak (≈40%)</b>      | "The soul is eternal and is reborn until liberated"                                                                                                                                                         | All schools merged; liberation terms used as synonyms                               |
| <b>Average (≈50%)</b>   | Correct school-wise definitions                                                                                                                                                                             | No argument reconstruction; Buddhism handled as an exception, not a counter-example |
| <b>Good (≈60%)</b>      | Continuity-bearer identified per school; one objection answered                                                                                                                                             | Necessary/sufficient distinction unstated                                           |
| <b>Strong (≈65-70%)</b> | Modal verdict precise; §5A distinctions live; Western comparator (Plato / resurrection) used                                                                                                                | Bhakti or the three-means dispute reduced to a list                                 |
| <b>Top (≈70%+)</b>      | All the above + a discriminating distinction (production vs removal model; <i>sākṣāt</i> vs <i>ārād-upakāra</i> ; SK 62-63 misattribution; replica theory) + a statement of what would falsify the position | -                                                                                   |

### Graded-verdict templates:

- ANALYSIS: *Necessity stem*: "Immortality of a substantial soul is **sufficient** for rebirth but not **necessary**: Buddhism secures re-becoming through causal continuity alone. What rebirth actually requires is a **continuity-bearer**, and schools disagree only about whether that bearer must be a substance."
- ANALYSIS: *Means stem*: "All three are means of different kinds. Which is the *direct* means is settled by a prior metaphysical question - whether liberation is produced or uncovered - and every school's answer follows from its answer to that."
- ANALYSIS: *Liberation-concept stem*: "The term names a family, not a state. Once *apavarga*, *kaivalya*, *mokṣa* and *nirvāṇa* are separated, the apparent Indian consensus on liberation turns out to be a shared vocabulary covering four incompatible destinations."

## Factual and Quotation Discipline

| Item                                                                                                   | Status                                                                                | Safe use                                                                               |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Plato's four arguments                                                                                 | FACT: <i>Phaedo</i> - cyclical, recollection, affinity, final (Form of Life) argument | Assess each separately; Simmias' harmony objection is in the same dialogue             |
| Gītā 2.22 (garments), 2.23 (weapons/fire/water/wind), 9.21, 18.66                                      | FACT: Verified chapter/verse                                                          | Translations vary - paraphrase, or quote a named translation                           |
| Gītā 5.4-5 ( <i>bālāh</i> , not <i>paṇḍitāh</i> )                                                      | FACT:                                                                                 | The single best warrant for the convergence reading                                    |
| <i>Bhāgavata Purāṇa</i> 7.5.23 ( <i>navadhā bhakti</i> )                                               | FACT:                                                                                 | Give all nine limbs, in order                                                          |
| <i>Nārada Bhakti Sūtra</i> / <i>Śaṇḍilya Bhakti Sūtra</i>                                              | FACT: Texts exist and define bhakti as supreme love/attachment                        | Do not attribute a date or an author-identification CAUTION:                           |
| <i>Vivekacūḍāmaṇi</i> 's definition of bhakti                                                          | CAUTION: Ascription to Śaṃkara is disputed                                            | Say "the Advaita tradition", not "Śaṃkara wrote"                                       |
| <i>Mārjāra/markaṭa-nyāya</i>                                                                           | FACT: Standard Śrīvaiṣṇava Teṅkalai/Vaḍakalai illustration                            | Use for the grace-effort problem                                                       |
| <i>Sāṃkhya-kārikā</i> 1 (threefold <i>duḥkha</i> ), 62-63 (no puruṣa is bound), 67-68 (potter's wheel) | FACT: Verified kārikā numbers                                                         | The 62-63 doctrine is the highest-value item in the module                             |
| <i>Yoga-sūtra</i> 1.2, 1.3, 1.24, 2.3, 4.29, 4.34                                                      | FACT: Verified sūtra numbers                                                          | 1.24 proves Yoga's Īśvara is not a creator                                             |
| Flame-to-flame / milk-to-curd                                                                          | FACT: Standard Buddhist illustrations (e.g. <i>Milindapañha</i> uses the lamp)        | Illustration, never proof                                                              |
| Replica theory                                                                                         | FACT: <b>John Hick</b> , <i>Philosophy of Religion / Death and Eternal Life</i>       | Present it as a <i>thought-experiment defence</i> , and give the duplication objection |
| <i>Immortality of the Soul or Resurrection of the Dead?</i>                                            | FACT: <b>Oscar Cullmann</b> (1955)                                                    | The canonical statement that the two are opposed                                       |
| "Potter's wheel" for <i>prārabdha</i>                                                                  | FACT: Used in both Advaita and Sāṃkhya                                                | Note the metaphysics differs even though the image is shared                           |

## Link-Outs to Related Topics

- Notions of God - the God-soul relation that fixes what liberation can be
- Problem of Evil - karma, desert and the distribution of suffering
- Religion without God - Yoga's non-creator Īśvara; Jain and Buddhist soteriology without a deity
- Religious Experience - *aparokṣānubhūti* as the cognitive event of liberation
- Paper I self/liberation theme
- Paper I: Sāṃkhya - 25 tattvas, *satkāryavāda*, *viveka-khyāti* -> §8.9
- Paper I: Yoga - *citta-vṛtti-nirodha*, *kleśas*, *aṣṭāṅga*, *kaivalya* -> §8.9
- Paper I: Buddhism
- Paper I: Jainism
- Paper I: Vedānta
- Paper I: Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika - *apavarga* and the eternal self-substance
- Philosophy of Religion PYQ Bank, 2018-2025

## Sources

- Plato, *Phaedo*.
- *Bhagavad Gītā*, especially Chapters 2, 5, 9 and 18; *Bhāgavata Purāṇa* 7.5.



- *Sāṃkhya-kārikā* of Īśvarakṛṣṇa; Patañjali, *Yoga-sūtra*, with the classical commentaries.
- John Hick, *Philosophy of Religion* and *Death and Eternal Life*; Oscar Cullmann, *Immortality of the Soul or Resurrection of the Dead?*
- Peter van Inwagen on the possibility of resurrection.
- S. C. Chatterjee & D. M. Datta, *An Introduction to Indian Philosophy*; C. D. Sharma, *A Critical Survey of Indian Philosophy*; S. Radhakrishnan, *Indian Philosophy*, Vols. I-II.

### Answer-specific execution and compression upgrades

Use these after the detailed models; they do not replace the models.

#### Ten-unit exam-application bridge - timed-paper upgrade

**How to improve this answer:** For the demand **Ten-unit exam-application bridge**, state the verdict in the introduction, reconstruct the relevant argument as premises leading to a conclusion, attach at least one named text/argument or canonical example to each major claim, present the strongest objection and reply, and finish with a qualified judgment rather than a thinker-summary.

**Executable compression plan:** 10 marks - thesis + 3 argument moves + 1 objection + verdict; 15 marks - thesis + 4-5 moves with named evidence + objection/reply + qualification; 20 marks - add interpretive dispute, disciplined comparison and a graded conclusion. Preserve technical terms and cut decorative biography first.

#### CANONICAL EXAM APPARATUS (PRESERVED VERBATIM) - timed-paper upgrade

**How to improve this answer:** For the demand **CANONICAL EXAM APPARATUS (PRESERVED VERBATIM)**, state the verdict in the introduction, reconstruct the relevant argument as premises leading to a conclusion, attach at least one named text/argument or canonical example to each major claim, present the strongest objection and reply, and finish with a qualified judgment rather than a thinker-summary.

**Executable compression plan:** 10 marks - thesis + 3 argument moves + 1 objection + verdict; 15 marks - thesis + 4-5 moves with named evidence + objection/reply + qualification; 20 marks - add interpretive dispute, disciplined comparison and a graded conclusion. Preserve technical terms and cut decorative biography first.